Standard Operating Procedure (SOP)

Country Specific Requirements Japan

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Applicability

Bayer Level: CH, PH

This document is electronically approved (signatures on the last page)

Distribution Sheet for Quality Regulations

Division/Business Unit ☒ PH ☒ CH

GBS Location
☐ Global Business Services Barcelona
☐ Global Business Services Costa Rica/Brazil
☐ Global Business Services Manila
☐ Global Business Services Gdansk
☐ Global Business Services India
☒ Global Business Services Dalian
☐ Global Business Services Germany

Region/ Country
☐ Global
☒ Specific Country: Japan

Relevance for R&D QMS
☐ Affected
☐ Interface
☒ N/A

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Table of Contents

1 Scope and Framework 5
1.1 Scope 5
1.2 Framework 5
2 Abbreviations 5
3 Purpose & Process 5
3.1 Purpose 5
3.2 General guidance 5
3.3 Roles and responsibilities 6
4 Specific requirements regarding PTC handling 7
4.1 Country Specific Requirements listed by different topics 7
4.1.1 General Information 7
4.1.2 Contact list 7
4.1.3 Pharmacovigilance cases 8
4.1.4 Product Samples 9
4.1.5 Statement letter 9
4.1.6 RQU Contact list 9
4.1.7 List of Local Opportunities Products 10
4.1.8 Data Privacy Requirements 10
4.1.9 Gathering additional information (including obtaining translation) 10
4.1.10 Reimbursement and Replacement 10
4.1.11 Exceptions and special cases 10
4.1.12 Others 10
5 External References 11
6 Internal References 11
7 History of Changes 11

1 Scope and Framework

1.1 Scope

Bayer Country Quality Units are accountable for a GMP compliant Product Technical Complaint Management within their respective countries. Within this responsibility they are supported by the respective Global Business Services in process steps like complaint initiation, forwarding for investigation to the RQU, and final verification including complaint sample management and reimbursement process.

This supplement defines clear guidance to the Global Business Services regarding all country specific requirements.

1.2 Framework

This supplement is based on principles and requirements outlined in SSC-PTC-SOP-001 “Manage Product Technical Complaint and Suspected Counterfeit Incidents in GBS”.

2 Abbreviations

AE	Adverse Event
CQH	Country Quality Head
CQU	Country Quality Unit
HCP	Healthcare Professional
PTC	Product Technical Complaint
PV	Pharmacovigilance
RD	Radiology Medical Device
RQU	Responsible Quality Unit
GBS	Global Business Services
GBS DLC	Global Business Services Dalian
PQS	Product Quality Safety Management
UI	Usability Issue
LODE	Lack of drug effect
LOE	Lack of effect

3 Purpose & Process

3.1 Purpose

Country Specific Requirements for Japan are described in this Supplement, regarding e.g. Data Privacy, Sample Handling Process, Reimbursement Process, Contacts, escalation rules.

During the processing of all PTCs by Bayer owned Global Business Services all country specific requirements are considered and followed besides the general complaint handling described in the SSC-PTC-SOP-001 “Manage Product Technical Complaint and Suspected Counterfeit Incidents in GBS”.

3.2 General guidance

The employees of the Global Business Services are following the supplement during complaint processing in Complaint Database on behalf of the Country Quality Units.

3.3 Roles and responsibilities

PTC GBS team	- manages PTCs and suspected falsification and counterfeit on behalf of the CQUs of the legal entity which introduces product into the market (e.g. Marketing Authorization Holder, Distribution license holder) - Enters PTCs, suspected falsification and counterfeit i and Usability Issues according to defined timelines, into the global complaint database in English language - forwards all cases that are not PTCs back to the CQU or applicable function for further processing - performs the initial intake of complaints after receipt and considering the information provided by the PV in case of an AE and/or a medical device (incl. Medical Device constituent of combination product) is involved - informs the respective PV about all PTCs with a potential associated AE or LODE or potentially reportable medical device complaints, including the unique complaint database number and all relevant follow-up information (e.g. Batch number) - informs the CQU about PTCs where local authorities are involved, about all potential falsification and counterfeits and any other cases described in the Country Specific SOPs - checks completeness and accuracy of information (including the photo or video, if available from the complainant) before forwarding the cases to the RQU - Initiates first contacts with the complainant within first 5 days of receipt of the complaint information to obtain follow-up information asks CQU for any support contacting the complainant if not possible/allowed by GBS (e.g. data privacy, non-hosted language) - ensures translation of non-hosted languages - forwards all cases to the respective RQU for further investigation and final assessment - checks if a complaint sample is available and starts the process to retrieve the sample, documenting these efforts including the number of attempts requesting sample in detail in complaint database - reviews the case for plausibility and closes the assessed complaint in complaint database - responds to the complainant, for PTC+AEs in liaison with the PVCH and documents the response in the global complaint database or other cross-referenced system in cooperation with the CQU - notifies the legal manufacturer of a device and where necessary, the manufacturer's authorized representative and the importer, if applicable.in case of any discussion or doubts contacts the CQH as the first line support
Country Quality Head (CQH) /	- ensures the appropriate handling of PTCs, and suspected falsified and counterfeit incidents, reported in the respective country including the timely execution of the related activities,

Country Quality Unit (CQU)	particularly for the entry of the cases into complaint database, forwarding them and for responding to the complainant - responds to the complainant, for PTC+AEs in liaison with the PVCH and documents the response in the global complaint database or other cross-referenced system in corporation with the Global Business Services - fulfills all obligations, e.g. PTC related reporting requirements defined by legislations or regulations - oversees and monitors the whole PTC process for products on market of their legal entity in case of delegation to GBS by controlling appropriate Key Performance Indicators according to GSOP 1372 “Perform Country Quality Management Review”. - support the process for reimbursement management

4 Specific requirements regarding PTC handling

4.1 Country Specific Requirements listed by different topics

Description	Assigned Roles & Document Reference

4.1.1 General Information

Bayer Yakuhin Ltd. (hereinafter referred to as “BYL”) and Bayer Life Science Ltd. (hereinafter referred to as “BLS”) (hereinafter referred to as “Bayer Japan”) are the legal entities for each MAH products in Japan. BLY perform PTC operations not only for BYL products but also for BLS products based on the contract with BLS. GBS located in city Dalian China, which is on behalf of BYL. to perform administrative part of PTC handling following roles and responsibilities.

CQU located in city Osaka Japan, which is on behalf of Bayer Japan.

4.1.2 Contact list

Item	E-mail address
CQH	Current name and email address of CQH and CQH deputy are found on the QINT SharePoint under country quality list.
General email address of CQU	BYL_PTC@bayer.com
cc to CQU for PV cases	0094-byl-mahm-pv-qa@bayer.com
CO/DC Group	0094-BYL-CO-CSM-CSO@bayer.com
PV case to BYL-PHV	*byl_ae_report@bayer.com*,
PV case to BLS-PHV	*bls_ae_report@bayer.com*
CQJ Group	0094-BYL-MAHM-CQJ-QIN <0094-byl-mahm-cqj-qin@bayer.com>
Quality Assurance Manager	BYL: kazuhide.mameda@bayer.com BLS: kyohei.yasuda@bayer.com
PV-PQS	pvptc@bayer.com
BYL-PV & QA	PTCJapan_AllRelevants@bayergroup.onmicrosoft.com

Description	Assigned Roles & Document Reference

Remark:
Current name and e-mail address of CQH and CQH deputy are found on the QINT SharePoint: *Country Quality List*

4.1.3 Pharmacovigilance cases

GBS

- If GBS PTC team received the complaint case is related to any type of Adverse Event, the JP PV Team must be notified via the following email address. CQU should also be notified as cc.

	To	CC
BYL product	byl_ae_report@bayer.com	0094-byl-mahm-pv-qa@bayer.com byl_phv_anseki@bayer.com fukiko.sakajiri.ext@bayer.com
BLS product	bls-ae-report@bayer.com	0094-byl-mahm-pv-qa@bayer.com bls-phv-anseki@bayer.com fukiko.sakajiri.ext@bayer.com

- If the JP PHV team reports AE-related case to SSF by email, the reports AE+PTC cases include Argus No. or Dev ID for Radiology (Medical device). Then the Dalian team will fill in with the information. If the Dalian team determines that entry of the reported case into Complaint Database is not necessary, the Dalian team provide JP PHV team with the reason.
- If the PV Team receives the information in the same email cycle, the GBS PTC team still needs to contact the pharmacovigilance department to obtain Argus No. or Dev ID for Radiology (Medical device).
- If GBS PTC team received the PTC only or AE-related case (PH/CH/Radiology) from PV-PQS team, then after entry into Complaint Database completely, shared the PTC ID and local ID to the following email address. If the case should not be entered into Complaint Database in accordance with the relevant Global SOP or Complaint Database User Letter, shared the following email address with rational.

	To	CC
BYL/ BLS product	pvptc@bayer.com	*PTCJapan_AllRelevants@bayergroup.onmicrosoft.com*

- If the JP PHV team/PV-PQS reports PTC only case or AE-related case to SSF by email, GBS assign the receipt number. The receipt number is to be the last two digits of the received year and the sequential number of the fourth are attached to the code of “SC” (e.g., SC-200001).
- All documents to assist in the investigation shall be converted into PDF format and stored in the Complaint database. For Radiology (Medical Device), once the GBS PTC team closed the case, need to send Complaint Database report in PDF format to PHV Team.

Description	Assigned Roles & Document Reference
4.1.4 Product Samples • Once PTC information is notified to Medical Representative or customer call center from HCP, Medical Representative visits the HCP, receive complaint sample and send it to CQU. CQU takes photos of all complaint sample and then send photos to GBS, GBS need upload the photos in Complaint Database to RQU for investigation. • When sample is documented as available in source, GBS enters it into Complaint Database and asks RQU to send email to CQU if sample requested. Then CQU sends the complaint sample to RQU accordingly. • If GBS receive Complaint Database automatic email which RQU request the complaint sample, GBS will inform CQU. • Regarding complaint sample of Radiology (Medical Device), it is sent only when requested by Bayer Medical Care. After receiving photo from CQU, GBS uploads photo into Complaint Database and sends email to notify RQU. If GBS is requested to provide the complaint sample by RQU, GBS pass the request to CQU promptly. • If complaint sample is not arrived at CQU office in one week after notification of PTC information, CQU sends email to medical representative to confirm if the complaint sample was sent to CQU, GBS is also in the email loop and GBS attaches the email to Complaint Database.	GBS /CQU
4.1.5 Statement letter **Acknowledgement Letter when a complaint comes in:** • When the complaint is entered into the Quality Complaint Report Form, Power Automate will send the link which archived the template of Acknowledgement Letter to the reporter (e.g. medical representative). • When the complaint is reported by other than the Quality Complaint Report Form, GBS need to send the link which archived the template of Acknowledgement Letter to the reporter. However, if the reporter is the person in CQU or PV, it is not needed to send. **Response Letter after closing:** • No action required from GBS, CQU takes actions accordingly	GBS/CQU
4.1.6 RQU Contact list A table with all available products in the country and the respective RQU contact names needed for the entry into Complaint Database is available and refers to “RQU list” is available on Share Point (go/ptc). This list will be updated timely by GBS and CQU if any changes awareness and be reviewed annually. List with the respective RQU contact names are also provided by the Divisional Quality Assurance function and available on the SharePoint: PH: *PH RQU responsible list_HJ.xlsx* CH: *IQMS_MASTER LIST COMPLAINT RESPONSIBILITIES.xlsx*	GBS /CQU

Description	Assigned Roles & Document Reference
4.1.7 List of Local Opportunities Products GBS DLC could found local opportunities products from “RQU list”. (See “4.1.6. RQU Contact list”)	GBS /CQU
4.1.8 Data Privacy Requirements Any personal information in the PDF file will be blacked out. Example: Name of the reporter, CWID of the reporter, agency informant, or any other information in the report that could identify an individual.	GBS
4.1.9 Gathering additional information (including obtaining translation) Translation is not required for Japan cases, since Japanese is a hosted language in GBS Dalian. If GBS PTC team needs to gather any additional information and/or if there is an unclear point of the information (e.g., difficult to understand the content of the complaint / which part complained / what happened) for inputting Complaint Database, GBS PTC team needs to check with the complaint sender. • Check by phone • Check by E-mail CQU mail address [BYL_PTC@bayer.com] in the CC field when confirming by email, CQU can understand the situation and support if necessary.	GBS/CQU
4.1.10 Reimbursement and Replacement No action required from GBS PTC team for reimbursement and replacement, CQU takes actions accordingly.	CQU
4.1.11 Exceptions and special cases GBS contact Japan PV team to report as AE, Special Situation without AE for pharmaceutical products or Potential harm to health without AE in accordance with the current SOP CQJ-0012-S02 Example of quality information that should be reported to SCM (DocID: IQMS-116905). For potential harm to health without AE, no need to raise the issue as an AE case in Complaint Database. For Radiology (Medical Device) case, GBS send Complaint Database final assessment report in PDF format to Japan PV team, once the GBS PTC team closed the case.	GBS
4.1.12 Others Regarding Radiology (Medical Device) products, FSR (Field Service Report) is a special information that assist in the investigation information needs to be translated from Japanese content into English and upload into Complaint database. Regarding complaint information, which is attached to the Quality Complaint Report Form, GBS will download the complaint information via Quality Complaint Report Form, and upload to the Complaint database. CQU check the information of Quality Complaint Report Form and should provide the attached information (e.g., photo of complaint sample) to GBS PTC team.	GBS CQU

5 External References

N/A

6 Internal References

Doc Label	Doc Type	Title
SSC-PTC-SOP-001	Standard Operating Procedure	Manage Product Technical Complaints and Suspected Counterfeit Incidents in GBS
SOP CQJ-0012-S02		Example of quality information that should be reported to SCM (DocID: IQMS-116905)

7 History of Changes

Version	Significant changes with respect to previous version	Effective date
1	• Country specific SOP template version up to 4.0, SSC-PTC-BP-002. V4.0, merged all information to current document from SSC-SOP-JP-004, version 1.0. Changed Document Label to SSC-PTC-SOP-JP-004. • Included row change for approvers. • Addition of Bayer Life Science Ltd. to Bayer Yakuhin Ltd as legal entity in Japan in session 4.1.1 General information. Add “BLS” email address in session 4.1.2 Contact list & 4.1. 4 Pharmacovigilance cases • Updated the contact list in session 4.1.2 • Removed User Letter 49 from session 4.1.12. • Addition of AVA500MPAT special case in session 4.1.12 to match the current approach of the country for handling complaints • Removed Session 7 Template, Annex 2, User letter 49 v1.0 in SSC-SOP-JP-004 version 1.0 and re-adjust the Annex number, Annex 1 is Product Complaint Form, Annex 2 is Acknowledgement.	2022-09-30
2	Same with 1.0	2022-09-30
3	• Add email address of PV-PQS and BYL-PV & QA to session 4.1.2 Contact list. • Updated GBS PTC team received the complaint case (PH/BT/CC) from PV-PQS team in session 4.1.4 Pharmacovigilance cases. • Changed SSCDN to GBS in all session, changed SCD to GBS DLC • Updated Abbreviations in session 2.0 • Updated the Exceptions and special cases in session 4.1.12 • Add SOP1-000-0990S02 in session 5 Internal References	2023-03-20
4	Bayer’s complaint database transferred from Dev@Com to Complaint Database on January 27, 2025, and the GSOP 115 revised to version 14.0 in parallel. Here listed all changes in SSC-PTC-SOP-001 version 6.0 to align with the current PTC handling procedure. • Update Distribution Sheet	See document’s effectivity in IQMS

	•Update through all the document reflecting Global SOP-115 version 14.0 updates. •Replace “Dev@Com” with “Complaint Database” •Added 2 Abbreviations content •Updated the 4.1.2 Contact list •Delete 4.1.3 Escalation Rules •Updated the method of sending the Acknowledgement Letter •Update 4.1.6 RQU Contact list •Update the 4.1.8 Data Privacy Requirements •Update the 4.1.12 Other information •Removed Annex 1 Product Complaint Form •Removed Annex 2 Acknowledgement Letter	

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